Sem 5

Assignment 2

DIGITAL OVERLOAD & TECH BURNOUT



USER STUDIES AND DESIGN RESEARCH

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TOPIC RECAP

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Topic Recap: Digital Overload and Tech Burnout

- Overexposure to digital tools is causing emotional exhaustion across professions.
- Doctors, in particular, face constant data input, screen fatigue, and emotional detachment.
- Primary research revealed that medical professionals often ignore self-care because patient well-being always comes first.

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Key Insights:

- Screen and shift overlap → sleep deprivation.
- Digital interruptions → empathy fatigue.
- No structured system for emotional recovery.

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How Might We

- HMW create friction that prevents late-night doomscrolling?
- HMW nudge mindful micro-breaks into long digital sessions?
- HMW help teams respect personal “offline” hours automatically?
- HMW provide simple, visual summaries of real impact (sleep/focus)?



REFINED PROBLEM STATEMENT .

Doctors are overconnected but under-supported.
Digital systems track every patient, but none track the doctor’s emotional well-being.
Existing wellness apps are generic and don’t align with hospital workflows.
There’s a need for a contextual, empathetic, and adaptive system designed for doctors, not just by IT teams.

TARGET RESEARCH EXTENSION

/1 **USER FEEDBACK**

/2 **COMPARITIVE ANALYSIS**

/3 **SECONDARY DATA**

USER FEEDBACK

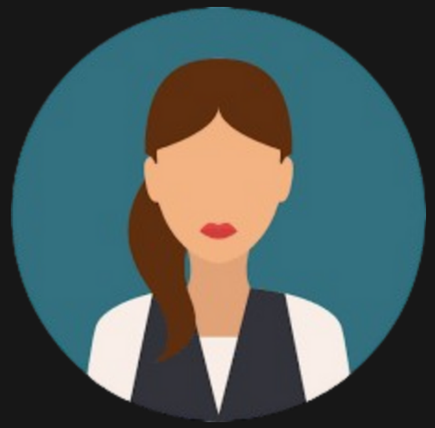


Dr. Bhushan | 36 | Gastroenterologist

Feedback:

- Finds current digital tools “too clinical” and detached from emotional well-being.
- Values peer discussions after emotionally draining cases but says “time rarely aligns.”
- Suggests a micro-community concept where doctors with similar specialties or patient experiences can connect briefly post-shift.
- Appreciates the idea of integration with existing hospital systems for automatic scheduling of recovery sessions after intense surgeries.
- Stresses need for privacy and non-judgmental tone — “Doctors don’t want to feel monitored.”

USER FEEDBACK



Dr. Anushka | 29 | Pediatrician

Feedback:

- Emotional fatigue often comes from empathetic overload — dealing with children's distress and anxious parents.
- Wants short "decompression check-ins" integrated into her daily planner — e.g., mood tracking synced with smartwatch.
- Liked the idea of a community wall where doctors share "one good moment from the day."
- Suggests including AI co-pilot summaries that reflect on emotional trends — "Your mood has improved since last week's lighter caseload."

USER FEEDBACK



Dr. Vipul | 54 | Forensic Medicine

Feedback:

- Notes that stress for forensic doctors is psychological rather than physical — exposure to crime, trauma, and courtroom pressure.
- Believes AI-based pattern recognition could help flag recurring stress indicators (sleep loss, erratic hours).
- Recommends a dual-mode system — one for structured recovery (scheduled breaks, mindfulness modules) and one for open forum sharing (community of similar specialists).
- Warns about data sensitivity and confidentiality, especially in medico-legal professions.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

EXISTING DIGITAL SOLUTIONS.

Platform	Core Focus	Limitations	Insights
Headspace/ Calm	Meditation & mindfulness for general users	Not contextually relevant to medical stress; lacks peer interaction	Needs domain-specific recovery cues (e.g., post-surgery decompression)
Wellness Portals in Hospitals	HR-driven programs (check-ins, webinars)	Institutional, impersonal; lacks confidentiality and emotional safety	Require personalization, anonymity, and community trust
Smartwatch Stress Monitors (Fitbit, Apple Health)	Physical stress indicators (HR, sleep, activity)	Tracks physiological data but ignores emotional context	Integration needed between emotional logs + biometric data

COMPARITIVE GAP MAPPING

	Current Systems	Observed Gaps	Opportunity Direction
Emotional Support	One-to-one therapy or meditation apps	No safe group/community for medical professionals	Build closed community clusters for shared empathy
Integration with Workflow	External tools, not part of daily schedule	Fragmented experience	Sync with hospital rosters, smartwatches, and co-pilot dashboards
Personal Data Sensitivity	Often linked to HR or public apps	Lack of trust due to data visibility	Encrypted, anonymous participation essential
Sustainability	One-time stress relief	No continuity or emotional tracking	Introduce ongoing emotional journey logsand gentle nudges

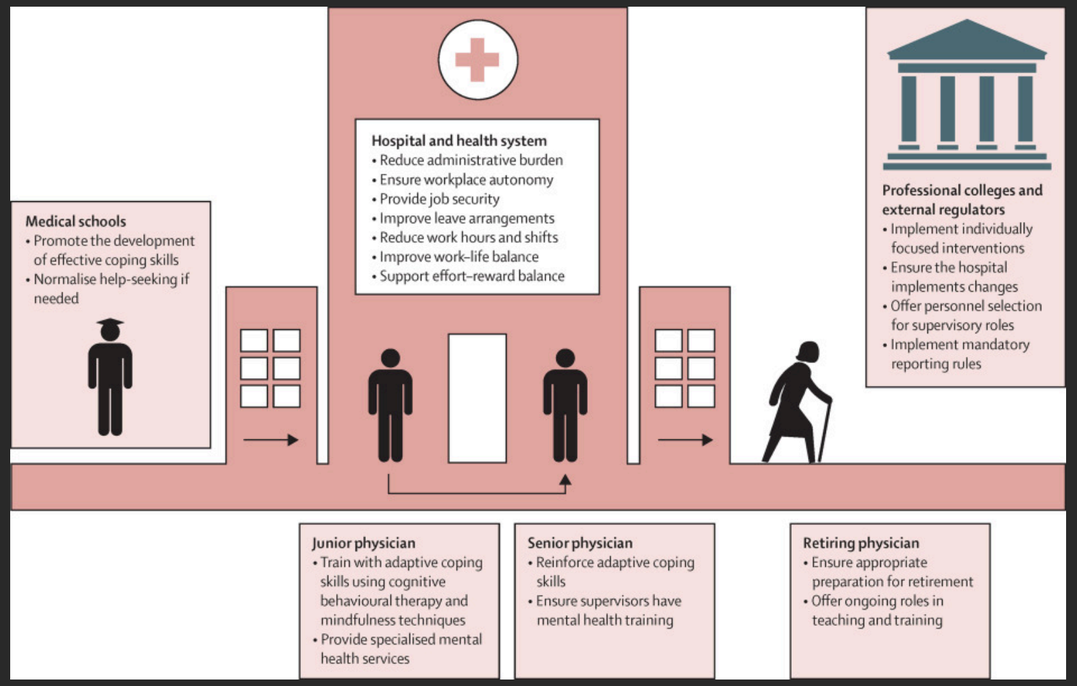
SECONDARY DATA SOURCES.

Title: **Mental illness and suicide among physicians**
Authors: SB Harvey, RM Epstein, et al.
Year: 2021

Key Insights:

- Physicians experience high rates of depression, anxiety and suicidal ideation; their mental health is systematically neglected.
- The problem stems not just from individual resilience, but from structural issues in workflow, emotional burden and workplace culture.

https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736(21)01596-8/fulltext



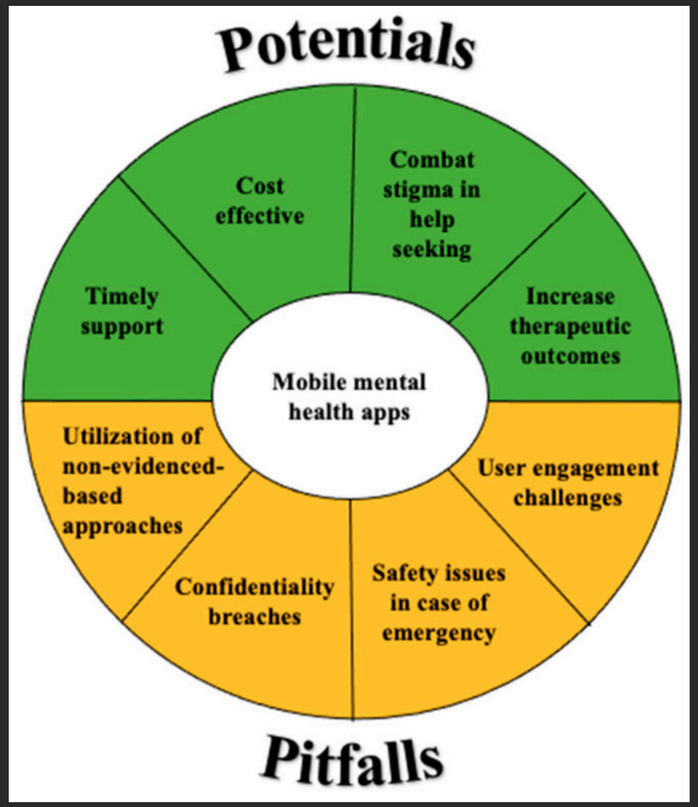
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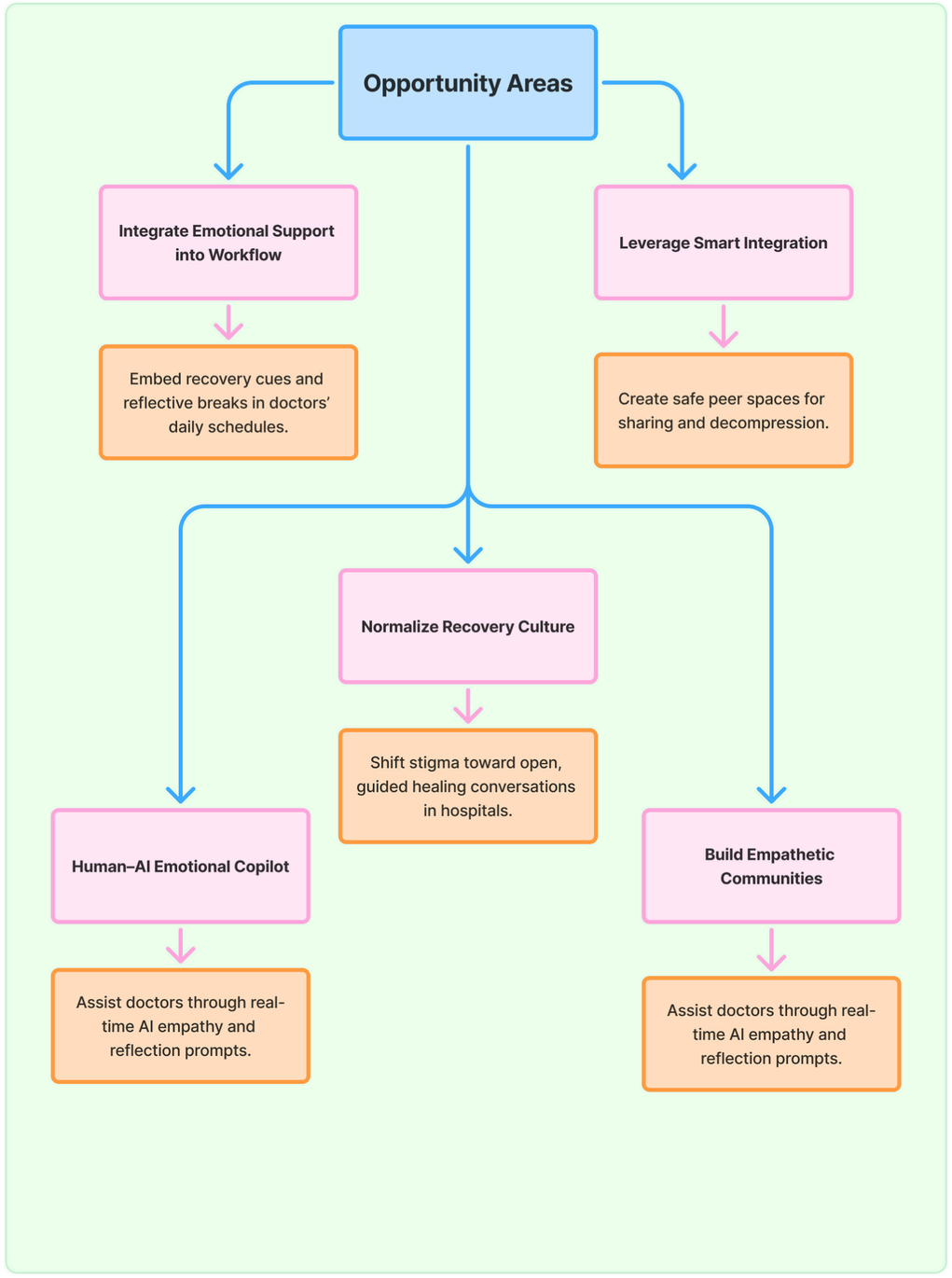
Title: **Potential and Pitfalls of Mobile Mental Health Apps in Traditional Treatment: An Umbrella Review**
Authors: J Koh, GYQ Tng, A Hartanto.
Year: 2022

Key Insights:

- Mental health apps offer promise (accessibility, cost-efficiency) but face major limits: lack of contextual integration, low long-term engagement, and no tailoring to specific professional groups like doctors.
- The study notes that apps alone are insufficient without community, workflow adaptation and professional support.

https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC9505389/





OPPORTUNITY AREAS

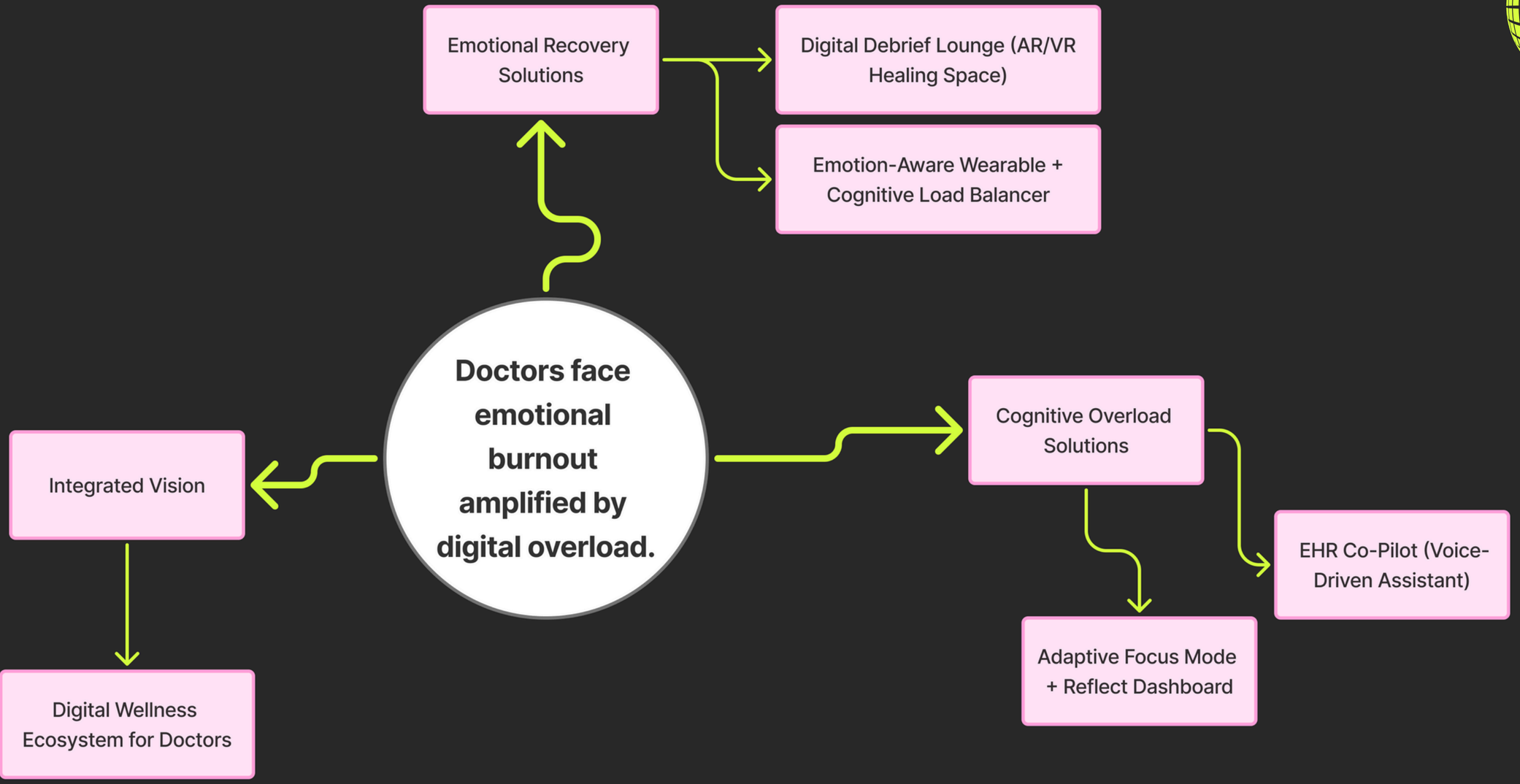
- 💡 Integrate Emotional Support into Workflow
- 🤝 Build Empathetic Communities
- ⌚ Leverage Smart Integration
- 🧩 Human–AI Emotional Copilot
- 🌱 Normalize Recovery Culture

View

View

IDEATION EVOLUTION





BRAINSTORMING

Daily tasks of work

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Emotional Recovery Zone
A calm physical space integrated into hospital corridors where doctors can take short guided breaks using micro rituals like breathing or reflection.

Healing Circle
A peer-led community space within hospitals for doctors to emotionally decompress and share experiences in a supportive circle.

The Reflection Wall
A hybrid digital-physical wall where doctors can anonymously post short gratitude notes or “good moments” to foster positivity and connection.

The Pulse Room
A small retreat area that uses ambient lighting and gentle sound therapy to help doctors self-regulate after high-stress cases.

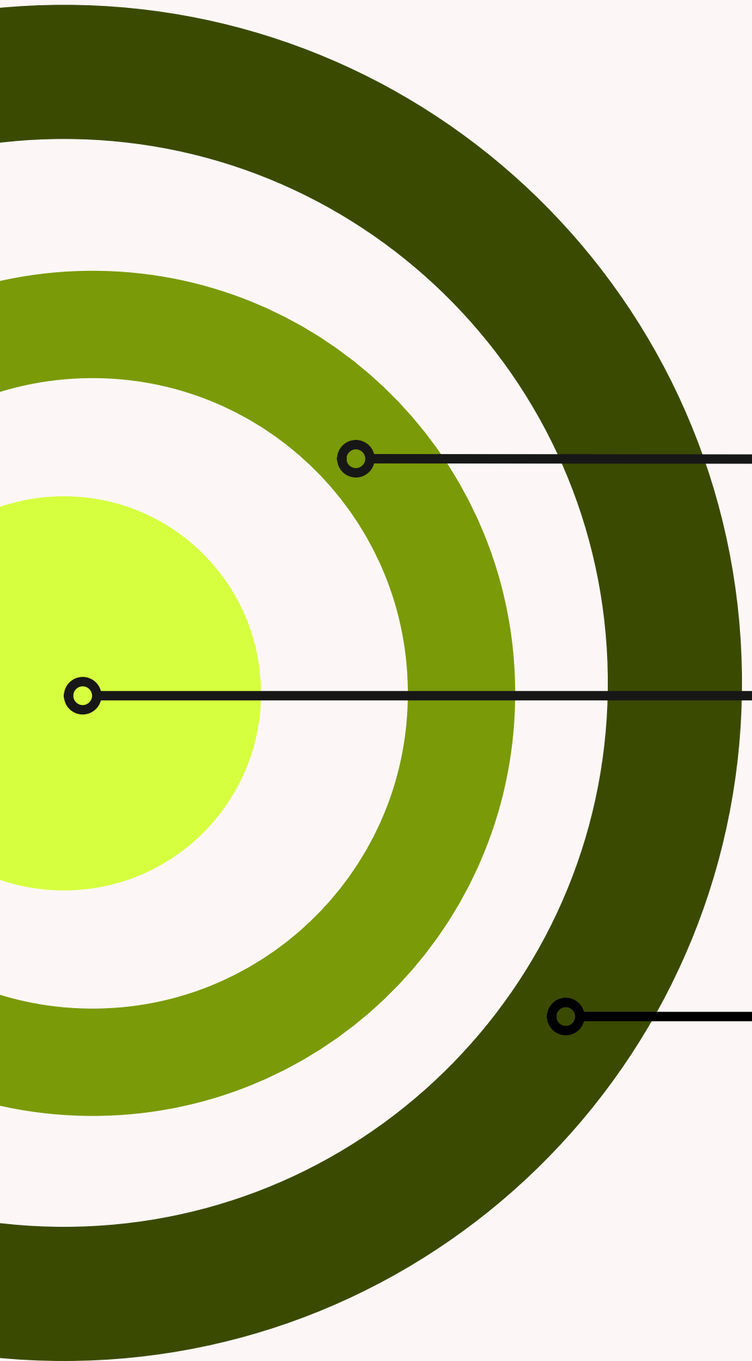
The Listening Loop
A rotating peer support system that pairs doctors for 5-minute debriefs after emotionally heavy interactions, encouraging shared empathy.

MindTrack Dashboard
A digital support tool that helps doctors track emotional patterns and recovery progress through reflection logs and mood summaries.

EHR Co-Pilot (AI Assistant)
A hands-free voice assistant that transcribes consultations in real time — allowing doctors to focus on empathy and eye contact.

Emotion-Aware Headset
A wearable headset that tracks stress indicators (heart rate, tone of voice) and suggests brief decompression prompts during long shifts.

CONCEPT DIAGRAM



INNER CIRCLE

- Debrief Zones
- Micro Rituals
- Peer Circles
- Facilitator Network

‘THE HEALING CIRCLE’

OUTER CIRCLE

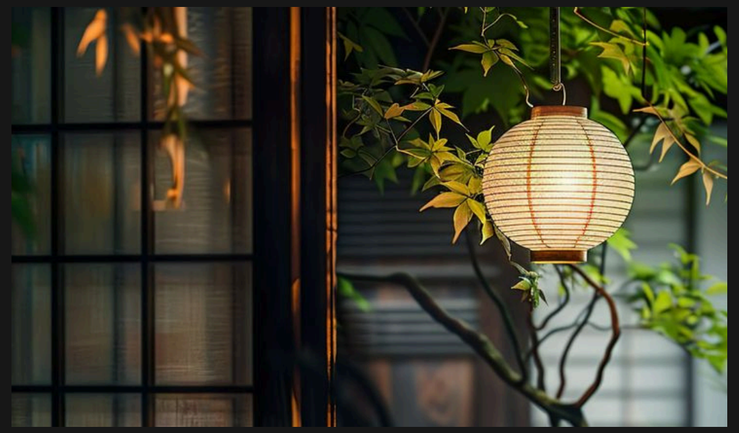
- Org Support
- Soft Digital Layer

PHYSICAL DEBRIEF ZONE

Plants



Soft lighting





Comfortable chairs



Neutral colors





Low table

MICRO RITUALS

“Simple, mindful pauses designed to help doctors decompress, reflect, and rebuild emotional balance.”

Gratitude Wall

Doctors leave quick anonymous notes — “Thanks for assisting” or “You handled that emergency so calmly.”

1 Minute Deep Breathing

Guided breathing via ambient sound or haptic pulse; inhale–exhale sync for 60 seconds.

Product Development

Build products that meet validated market needs.

Healing Playlist / Story

QR-linked shared audio playlist or short reflective voice notes from peers on tough days.

WHAT HEALING CIRCLE ACTUALLY *IS*

Physical Debrief Zones

- These are calm, purpose-built spaces located close to clinical areas designed to help staff pause, breathe, and reset.

- They feature soft lighting, comfortable seating, and gentle nature-inspired visuals, with noise-dampening to create a quiet, restorative environment. A small table, water station, and minimal signage keep the space simple and welcoming.



Micro-Rituals: Quick Reset Moments

Short, built-in practices that help staff decompress throughout the day.

- 1-minute deep breathing to recentre
- 3-minute gratitude check-in to refocus on positives.
- 5-minute reflective writing prompt to process emotions.
- 10-minute guided peer debrief to talk through challenging cases.



WHAT HEALING CIRCLE ACTUALLY *IS*

Peer Healing Circles

- Small groups of 4–6 peers meet weekly or biweekly for 10–20 minutes to share experiences, reflect, and relieve stress in a safe, supportive space.
- Guided by a trained facilitator or counsellor, sessions can be in person or virtual (audio-only) with an option for anonymity to ensure comfort and openness.



Facilitator Network

- A network of rotating doctors, trained facilitators, or counsellors who lead the circles.
- Each facilitator uses a short script and a curated question bank to guide meaningful, balanced conversations.
- Every department has trained champions to help organize sessions and encourage participation.



WHAT HEALING CIRCLE ACTUALLY *IS*

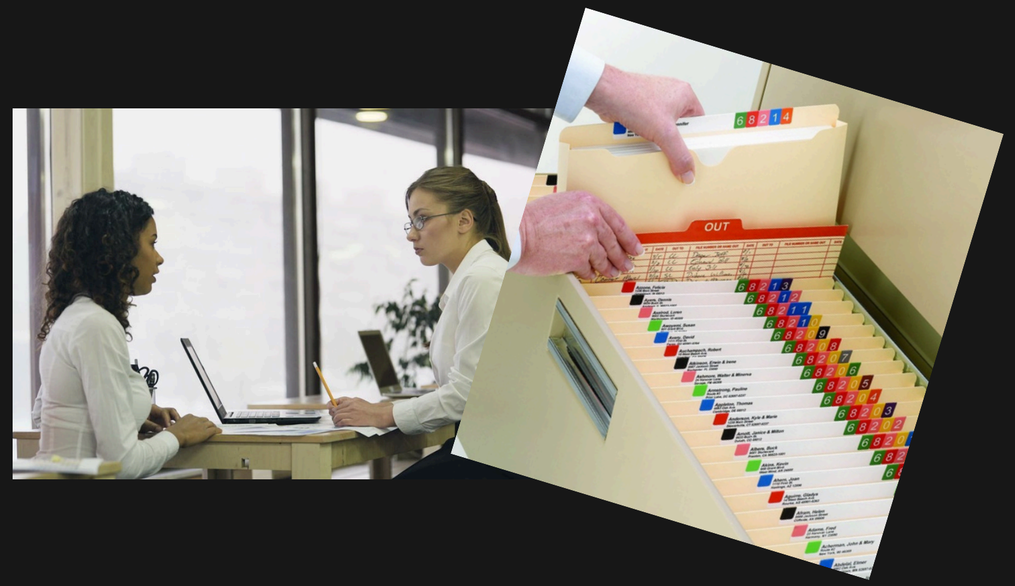
Soft Digital Layer

- A light digital setup uses QR codes, SMS/WhatsApp updates and an anonymous mood wall to make coordination easy and low effort.
- It’s not a full app just small, practical tools for scheduling and anonymous check ins without adding tech complexity.



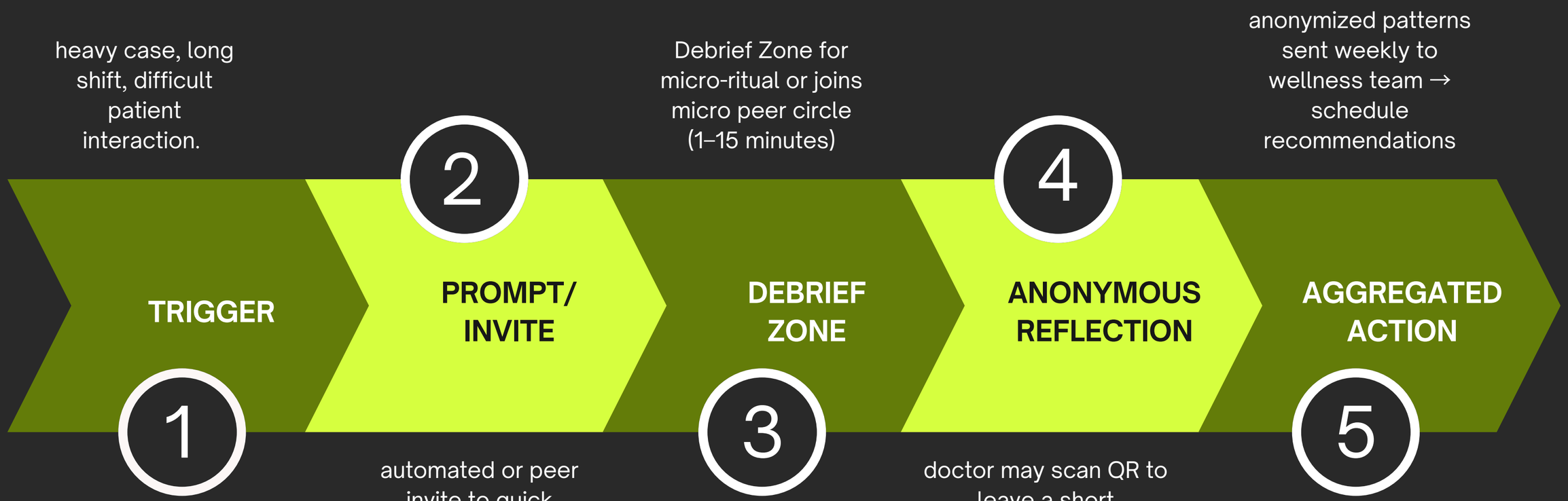
Organizational Integration

- The HR and wellness teams receive only aggregated, anonymous insights, ensuring full privacy.
- These insights support policy changes like adding protected micro-breaks and integrating recovery time into staff schedules to promote well-being.



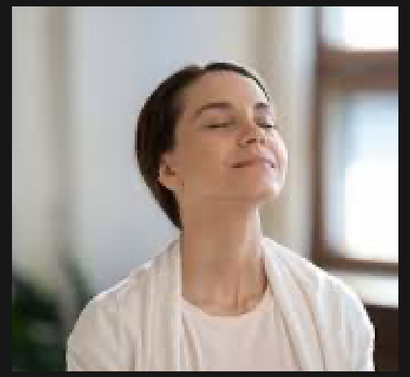
FLOW MAP

"This flow shows how a stressful moment transforms into reflection, connection, and recovery — making healing a natural part of a doctor's routine."



INTERACTION TOUCHPOINTS

Touchpoint	Essence (What Happens + Who)
Pre-Shift Onboarding	Admin introduces “Healing Circle” — optional 10-min micro-breaks added to roster.
In-Shift Prompt	Nurse or peer gently reminds doctor for a 2-min breathing pause after tough case.
Post-Case Micro-Ritual	Doctor enters quiet zone, uses guided reflection or quick audio debrief.
End-of-Shift Circle	15-min “one highlight, one challenge” round; led by peer facilitator.







INTERACTION TOUCHPOINTS

Touchpoint	Essence (What Happens + Who)
Weekly Peer Circle	Specialty group (pediatrics, ER, etc.) gathers for longer emotional check-in.
Reflection Wall	QR wall for short anonymous notes of gratitude or moments of pride.
Org Feedback Loop	HR gets anonymized insights → shapes better schedules and support.





WHY HEALING CIRCLE?
RATIONALE

1. Rooted in Real Need

- Tackles burnout and emotional fatigue among doctors.
- Turns stress moments into shared recovery experiences.

2. Community-Based Healing

- Encourages empathy, peer connection, and trust.
- Creates safe spaces for open reflection within teams.

3. Simple, Scalable System

- Uses short, low-effort micro-rituals built into shifts.
- Easy to adopt across departments with minimal setup.

4. Feasible and Impactful

- Low-cost pilot model with long-term well-being benefits.
- Improves morale, retention, and quality of care.



THANK YOU





